

points. Some Backgrounds may be pooled among changelings in a motley. For more information, see “Pooling Backgrounds” on p. 171.

Chimera

Chimera includes both chimerical items and chimerical companions. The player must designate one or both of these variations on the character sheet. This Background may have up to five dots in both versions. For more information on chimerical items, creating a companion from the points provided by the Background, and examples, see **Chapter Seven: The Dreaming**.

Chimerical Items

Every changeling’s voile, his chimerical clothing, forms to suit him upon his Chrysalis. The Chimera Background represents any chimerical items in his possession beyond this. The item’s usefulness and power determine the rating for this Background. Each dot represents one rank on the threshold chart under “Creating Chimerical Items” on p. 317.

- You own a chimerical memento or conversation piece (Basic crafting).
- Your chimerical item conveys some useful benefit (Advanced crafting).
- You have a moderately powerful chimerical item (Complex crafting).
- You own a powerful chimerical item (Masterwork crafting).
- Your chimerical item is legendary (Legendary crafting).

Chimerical Companions

Companions are living chimera either born of unconscious dreams or sculpted into existence from raw dream stuff, then breathed life by a changeling. While the character has either befriended or bound the chimera, powerful ones have motivations of their own that may occasionally conflict with those of their companions. The higher a changeling’s rating in this Background, the more points the player has to build the companion, using the system on p. 320.

- You have a simple chimerical pet (20 points).
- Your chimera is semi-intelligent and able to communicate (25 points).
- The chimera is able to speak clearly and often has a mind of its own (30 points).
- You have a highly intelligent chimera that is often a great help (40 points).
- Your friend is an ancient and/or powerful chimera that is a legend in its own right (60 points).

Contacts

Contacts are the people a character can call upon for information and assistance. While Contacts might be friendly, they will not exert their influence or give up their knowledge without a quid pro quo or expectation of a future favor. The

player should describe his major Contacts in some detail, such as their professions or sphere of influence.

In addition to his major contacts, the character also has a number of minor contacts. To get in touch with them, the player rolls his Manipulation or Wits + Contacts rating (difficulty 7). Each success allows the character to speak with one minor contact. He can then bully, bribe, or deal with the contact to get what he is after.

The Contacts Background may be pooled among characters in the motley.

- One major contact.
- Two major contacts.
- Three major contacts.
- Four major contacts.
- Five major contacts.

Dreamers

Changelings primarily gain Glamour by inspiring Dreamers. This Background represents the number of Dreamers from whom the character draws Glamour. Cultivating a Dreamer is an intimate experience of psychological bonding, whether through trust or fear. A Dreamer is usually willing to perform services for her changeling, but isn’t as loyal or efficient as Retinue. The player should describe details such as how the changeling inspires the Dreamer and what form the Dreamer’s Glamour takes.

Because of their unique bond, the changeling already knows how to inspire her Dreamer. Each dot of the Dreamers Background provides one automatic success on the initial Perception + Kenning roll when initiating Reverie. For more unsavory changelings, this Background provides a ready pool of Dreamers on which to Ravage.

- You benefit from one Dreamer.
- You benefit from two Dreamers.
- You benefit from four Dreamers.
- You benefit from six Dreamers.
- You benefit from eight Dreamers.

Holdings

Freeholds, no matter the size, are extremely rare, valuable commodities in faerie society. Though being the keeper of a freehold provides a steady supply of Glamour, responsibility for it comes with a number of obligations. He must maintain it each year to keep its balefire burning. If he’s a noble, modernist commoners might see his Holding as a symbol of oppression and seek to liberate it. If he is a commoner, traditionalist nobles might see it as an affront to the natural order and seek to restore the freehold to its proper owners. If he holds it in secret, changelings who get wind of it might jealously seek it for themselves.

The Holdings rating determines the amount of Glamour the freehold produces and its physical size. For more information about freeholds and examples, see **Chapter Seven: The**